



Australian Government
National Indigenous
Australians Agency



NIAA



NAIDOC Local Grants Opportunity

2026 Applicants Guide

Tips, Hints and Getting Help

Working with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples



OFFICIAL

QUICK TIPS

NAIDOC Local Grants are available for **activities held across Australia, to celebrate**

NAIDOC Week - 5 to 12 July 2026

by Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities and supporting organisations.



NAIDOC Local Grants funding provides a **contribution** towards the cost of local NAIDOC Week activities – you should have other sources of financial or non-financial (in-kind) co-contributions



Grant activities must meet the objectives of the NAIDOC Local Grants Opportunity, including supporting the expression, engagement and re-vitalisation of First Nations cultures; and celebrating the history, culture and achievements of First Nations peoples.

Activities funded by a NAIDOC Local Grant are encouraged to promote the NAIDOC Week theme.



Contents

Introduction	5
NAIDOC Week.....	6
NAIDOC Week Theme	6
NAIDOC Local Grants.....	6
Funding Availability	7
Funding Streams	7
Educational Institutions	7
Co-contributions.....	7
Your Activity	9
Types of activities	9
Locations and multiple events	9
Helpful Resources.....	11
Free Educational Resources	11
Other Funding Opportunities	11
Grant Outcomes	13
Funding preference priorities	13
What are my chances of getting a grant?	13
What's the main reason applications are ineligible?	13
The Application Form	15
Starting your application and coming back to it later	15
Applicant contacts.....	16
First things first.....	16
Letters of Support	17
Bank account details.....	17
NSW and WA public schools.....	18
Organisation details.....	18
Organisation title	18
Your entity type	19
Other Unincorporated Entity	20
Identifying as an Indigenous organisation	21



Telling us about your activity	22
Activity title	22
Activity description	22
A note on the NAIDOC Week Theme	23
Using Artificial Intelligence (AI)	24
When can I hold my activity?	25
Indigenous location (ILOC) information	25
Selection criterion response (Large-scale grants only)	27
Financials.....	29
Budget.....	29
COVID-19	29
Completing the Application Form	30
Submitting your form.....	30
Started (but not submitted) before closing time	30
Late applications	30
Getting Help	31
Successful Applications	32
Funding acknowledgement	32
Changing the date of your activity	32
Changes to your activity	33
Withdrawing if you can't hold the activity	33
Unspent grant funds.....	33
Acquitting the grant	33



Introduction

This document provides information about NAIDOC Week and practical tips about applying for a NAIDOC Local Grant. It should be read in conjunction with the 2026 NAIDOC Local Grants Opportunity - Grant Opportunity Guidelines (the Guidelines).

This Applicants Guide is intended to be a simple language document to assist you with planning and preparing your application and to answer many frequently asked questions. We have referenced some of the sections of the Guidelines which should be referred to for more detail.

It's important that you read and understand all the documents on [GrantConnect](#) (including the Guidelines, the Bank Account Verification Document, the Indigenous Locations (ILOC) Tip Sheet and the sample Letter of Offer and Schedule) before submitting an application.

If after reading these documents you can't find the answer to your question, please email NAIDOCgrants@niaa.gov.au.

We are a small team, but we'll do our best to get back to you within three working days.



NAIDOC Week

[NAIDOC Week](#) is a grassroots celebration for Australia's Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples and communities. NAIDOC Week is a time for Australians of all backgrounds to respect, embrace and celebrate Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander histories and cultures.

Since 1975, NAIDOC Week has been held from the first to the second Sunday in July.

In 2026, NAIDOC Week will run from 5 to 12 July.

NAIDOC Week Theme

Each year, the [National NAIDOC Committee](#) provides a theme that celebrates the histories and cultures of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples. The theme is publicly announced in advance of NAIDOC Week and celebrated through NAIDOC activities, including the National NAIDOC Awards Ceremony and the [National NAIDOC Poster](#) Competition.

More information on the NAIDOC Week theme for 2026 can be found on the [NAIDOC website](#) once announced.

Grant recipients are encouraged to promote the annual NAIDOC Week theme through their activity.

NAIDOC Local Grants

The Australian Government helps fund activities to celebrate NAIDOC Week. NAIDOC Local Grants funded activities must support the objectives of the NAIDOC Local Grants Opportunity, which are to:

- support the expression, engagement and re-vitalisation of First Nations cultures
- celebrate the history, culture and achievements of First Nations people
- increase First Nations peoples' participation in the social and economic life of Australia, and
- promote broader understanding and acceptance of the unique place of First Nations cultures in Australian society.

NAIDOC Local Grants are available primarily for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities and supporting organisations to celebrate NAIDOC Week.

Non-Indigenous organisations are strongly encouraged to work with their local Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander community in planning activities.



Funding Availability

In 2026, \$3.0 million¹ will be available for NAIDOC Local Grants funded activities nation-wide.

Funding Streams

There are three funding streams available under this grant opportunity:

1. Educational Institutions – for grants valued up to \$1,500
2. Small-Scale grants – for grants of \$10,000 or less
3. Large-Scale grants – for grants of more than \$10,000 and up to \$25,000.

The majority of grants awarded are generally for \$10,000 or less. Only a limited number of grants is expected to be awarded for more than \$10,000 and up to \$25,000 – primarily for larger community activities.

Additional information regarding funding streams can be found in **Section 2.1** of the Guidelines.

Educational Institutions

If you are applying for, or on behalf of, a **single** educational institution you can only apply under Stream One.

If you are applying to undertake an activity for, or on behalf of, **multiple** educational institutions, you may submit an application under Stream Two – Small-Scale grants. However, prior to submitting your application, you should seek approval by contacting NAIDOCGrants@niaa.gov.au.

An educational institution is defined as a place where people of different ages gain an education, including preschools, early learning/childcare centres, primary-elementary schools, secondary-high schools, Technical and Further Education (TAFE) and universities. Parents and community (P&C associations) and school holiday programs also fall under this definition.

Educational Institutions are strongly encouraged to use grant funding towards First Nations community involvement in their activity.

Co-contributions

NAIDOC Local Grants funding is intended to provide a **contribution** towards the cost of your proposed activity – not the full running costs. All applicants should have co-contributions from other sources, which may be financial or non-financial (in-kind). Providing details of co-contributions may strengthen your application.

¹ All amounts in this Guide are GST exclusive



The Glossary (at **Section 15** of the Guidelines) includes a definition of what a co-contribution is.

Examples of **financial** co-contributions include monetary donations, other non-Commonwealth Government grant funding, ticket sales, entry fees or commercial borrowings. Examples of **non-financial** co-contributions include volunteer labour or donated goods or services, including equipment or venue hire (such as BBQ supplies, vouchers, prizes etc.).

Co-contributions could be provided by your own organisation, or by community organisations or businesses who support your proposal. For example:

- you might have a local council or business who is willing to offer you a donation of goods (such as meat for the barbeque) or services (advertising for the activity)
- you might also receive non-financial co-contributions like free venue/local oval hire, speakers or performers who are willing to reduce their fee, or community groups who will volunteer to do the cooking
- for activities that require participants to pay an entrance fee or buy a ticket to attend, you should include the estimated funds to be raised as unconfirmed funding.

Section 5.4 of the Guidelines provides a list of items that are out-of-scope for NAIDOC Local Grants funding. However, these items could be funded by your, or another, organisation as a co-contribution.



Your Activity

Types of activities

Section 5 of the Guidelines outlines the type of activities we may fund. Examples of the types of activities we may fund include:

- ✚ arts based activities, including design work, painting, dancing, crafts and storytelling
- ✚ family fun days
- ✚ cultural activities, including Welcome to Country
- ✚ Elders activities
- ✚ bush tucker and other community cooking activities
- ✚ NAIDOC themed sporting activities or competitions, and
- ✚ activities that actively promote reconciliation.

The [NAIDOC website](#) is a great place for suggestions on how to celebrate NAIDOC Week - visit the website to:

- find some ideas for celebrating on the [plan your own event](#) page and in the [Supporting NAIDOC Toolkit](#) (for non-Indigenous organisations, this has some great tips to make sure you are appreciating culture, not appropriating it)
- get in touch with your [local NAIDOC Committee](#) and find out what their plans are, or
- check out the [Local NAIDOC Week events](#) register to find out what other people are doing (and to register your event).

You can also reach out to your Local Aboriginal Land Council in your State or Territory to find out if they can help or work with you. You can find a list [here](#).

Locations and multiple events

As in previous years, we only accept one application from each organisation per NIAA Region.

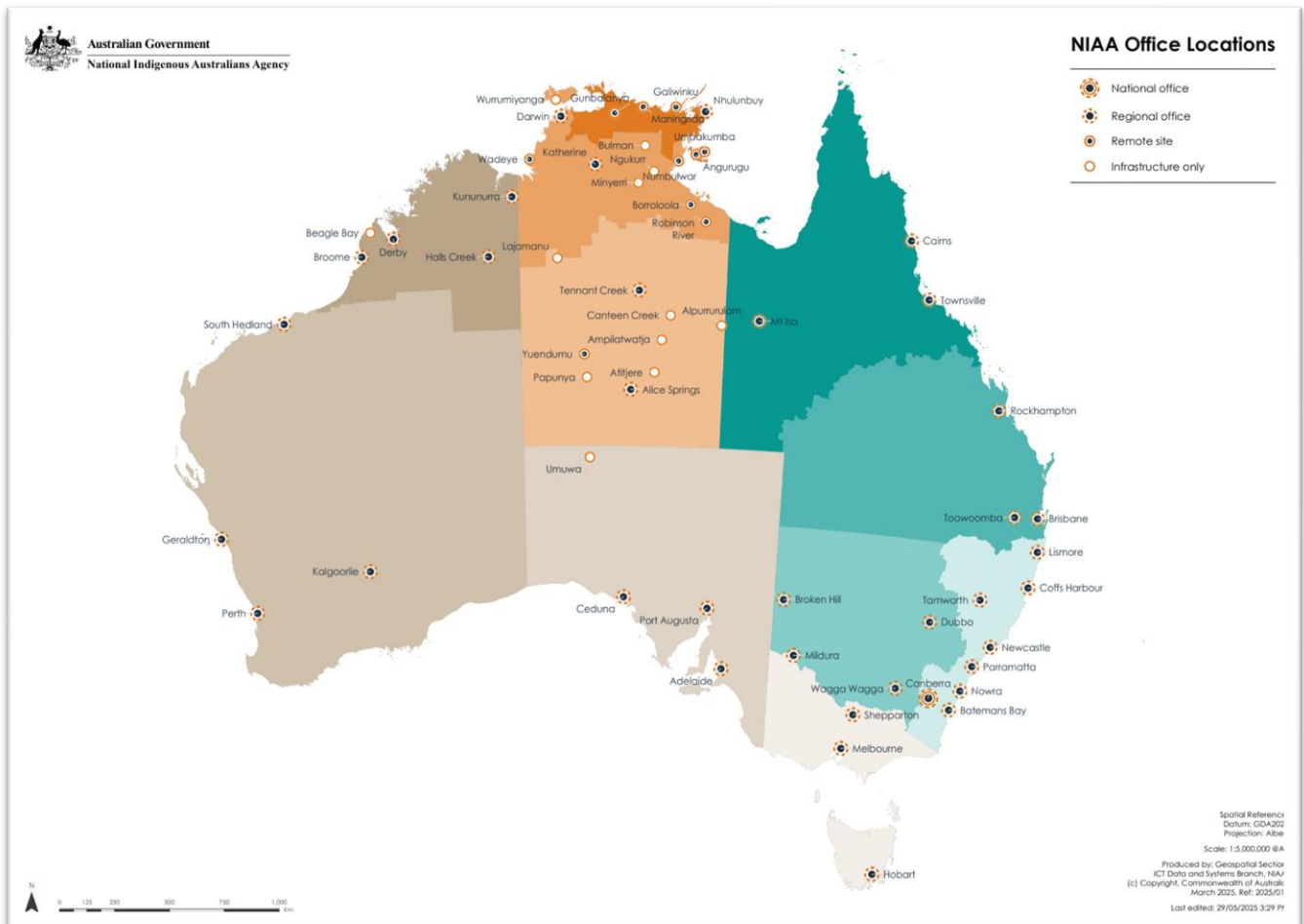
You can use the map below to identify which NIAA Region your activity will be located in. If you are unsure of the NIAA Region, please contact your local [NIAA Regional Office](#) or email NAIDOCGrants@niaa.gov.au.

You can hold multiple activities in the same NIAA Region; however, you should only submit one application covering all activities in that Region. You can also hold multiple activities in different NIAA Regions, but you'll need to submit a separate application for each NIAA Region. This is because each NIAA Region has its own funding allocation and cannot fund activities outside its own area.

Section 3.1 of the Guidelines has more information about applying across multiple locations.



Your organisation may be part of a bigger company or sit under a government agency – e.g. a regional health service under a state health department or a local childcare centre under a national company. If the activity will be managed by different staff and held at separate locations, you can submit separate applications for each site.



Map: NIAA regions and office locations



Helpful Resources

Free Educational Resources

Curriculum resources and other activities that are the core business of educational institutions are out-of-scope for funding. We recommend you explore the links below for free resources:

- [Educational resources | NAIDOC](#)
- [First Nations Curriculum Resources | Classroom Learning | Australians Together](#)
- [Australian Children's Television Foundation](#)
- [SBS NAIDOC Website](#)
- [Koori Curriculum](#)
- [Education Resources - Culture is Life](#)

Other Funding Opportunities

Some State and Territory Governments and / or Local Councils also offer grant opportunities for NAIDOC related activities which you may be eligible to apply for.

Funding from other sources, including other grants, can be considered a financial co-contribution towards your activity and you can include this in the co-contributions section of the application form. If you do not know the outcome of funding applied for under another grant process, you can include it as 'unconfirmed' funding (for Large-scale Grants only).

Below are some examples of other funding opportunities that were available in 2024-25 or are currently available for 2025-26. Please note that other opportunities may also exist, depending on your location and the nature of your activity.

Australian Capital Territory (ACT)

- ACT Government - 2024-25 Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Grant Program
- See [ACT Funding and support](#) for future opportunities

New South Wales (NSW)

- [NSW Government - 2025 NAIDOC Grants Program](#)
- See [Grants and funding](#) for future opportunities

Victoria (VIC)

- [Victoria State Government – 2025-26 Aboriginal Sport Participation Grant Program](#)
- [City of Melbourne – 2025-26 Aboriginal Community Grants](#)

Western Australia (WA)

- [City of Wanneroo - Community Funding Program](#)



Northern Territory (NT)

- [City of Darwin - Reconciliation Week and NAIDOC Week Funding](#)

Queensland

- [Queensland Government – 2025 NAIDOC Week event funding](#)
- See [Queensland Government Grants Finder](#) for future opportunities



Grant Outcomes

Funding preference priorities

NAIDOC Week is, first and foremost, a grassroots celebration for First Nations people to showcase and celebrate the histories, culture and achievements of their people and communities. Keeping that in mind, it is important that Indigenous organisations are enabled to deliver activities in their communities.

To achieve this, we will give funding preference priority to organisations with high levels of Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander representation when distributing funding across each NIAA Region.

Non-Indigenous organisations proposing to hold a NAIDOC activity should work with their local Indigenous organisations and/or community to ensure the activity is undertaken in a culturally appropriate manner. We strongly encourage non-Indigenous organisations to provide a Letter of Support to demonstrate this.

Further information on funding preference priorities is included at **Section 3.3** of the Guidelines. A definition of an Indigenous organisation is provided in the Glossary at **Section 15** of the Guidelines.

What are my chances of getting a grant?

In 2025 we received 1,115 applications seeking over \$11.0 million. Approximately 50 per cent of eligible applicants were funded from the \$3.0 million available.

Not all applications assessed as being eligible for funding are guaranteed to be offered a grant. Due to the high demand for funding, please bear in mind that even a strong application from an organisation that has previously been funded may not be successful every year. Additionally, successful applicants may not receive the full amount applied for.

It is expected that most grants will be awarded for \$10,000 or less. As we give funding preference to Indigenous organisations (see **Section 3.3** of the Guidelines) this may impact on the number of grants awarded in Stream One - Educational Institutions.

What's the main reason applications are ineligible?

Of the 1,115 applications received in 2025, 195 were deemed ineligible due to a range of factors including having submitted:

- multiple applications from the same organisation within a single NIAA Region
- a single application for the same activity across multiple NIAA Regions, or
- invalid bank statements.



In addition to these examples, an application will be deemed ineligible if it seeks funding primarily for out-of-scope items – see **Section 5.4** of the Guidelines.

If we find your application is non-compliant following our Compliance, Completeness and Eligibility checks, we will aim to notify you around April 2026. This notification will include feedback about why your application was ineligible to assist with any application you may submit for a NAIDOC Local Grant in the future.

To avoid the disappointment of having your application deemed ineligible, please make sure it meets the requirements outlined in **Section 3.1** and **Section 4.1** of the Guidelines.

To ensure you provide valid bank account verification details, please see the **Bank Account Verification Document** available on [GrantConnect](#). This document provides examples of what documentation is acceptable and not acceptable for this purpose.

When will I find out the outcome of my application?

We expect that Letters of Offer will be sent to successful applicants in late-May to June 2026. Unsuccessful applicants will also be advised around this time.



The Application Form

This section of the Applicants Guide provides guidance on how to complete various sections of the application form. The information is generally provided in the order that it appears in the application form.

Starting your application and coming back to it later

When you start an application, a 'Form Opened' email will be sent to the primary contact you've listed. This will include a link to the Application Form as well as a **Submission Reference**.

You will receive a Form Submitted receipt that looks like this:

Form Opened

You opened and saved an application form for **2026 NAIDOC Local Grants Opportunity**

Your form submission reference is: [REDACTED]

This Application process will close at **3:00pm Australian Eastern Daylight Time (AEDT) Thursday 19 February 2026**.

Return directly to your saved form [here](#).

IMPORTANT INFORMATION:

More than one person should not access this form at the same time. If this is done there is a risk that information entered in the form may be lost and not transferred upon submission. If you wish to share this form and access details, please ensure that only one user edits the form at any given time.

To avoid any issues with your submission, ensure each contributor has completed their updates, saved their changes and exited the form prior to another person accessing the same form.

Your form will be accessible for 60 days from the last date accessed or the close date/time of the round, whichever date is earliest.

If you have any questions relating to this Application, phone **1800079098** or email NAIDOCgrants@niaa.gov.au.

Please do not reply to this email as it has been sent from an automated system and replies are routed to an unmonitored mailbox. For further information regarding your form please contact the relevant Government Agency.

Keep hold of this email, as you'll need your Submission Reference ID if you want to take a break and access the form later. If you lose this email you will need to contact the Community Grants Hub at [Contact us | Community Grants Hub](#) to retrieve your Submission Reference ID.

Use the **Continue** button to progress through the form. If you need to exit your application, make sure it has been saved by clicking on:

- **Save and Close**, and



- **Confirm.**

Make sure you click **Confirm** or your application won't be saved.

Once your application has been saved, you will be taken to the **Form Saved** page. You can then return to your application or exit and come back later.

Applicant contacts

We need your help to make sure we can tell you if you have been offered a grant.

Sometimes the person who submits the application leaves the organisation and our email goes to an inactive account. It would be unfortunate if you missed out on a grant because of this.

Think about using or setting up an email address that a few people in your organisation can access, or using a general inquiries phone number (rather than relying on an individual's phone number).

Please **keep checking your spam or junk mail account and voicemail/message bank** as emails and phone call messages from NIAA and/or the Community Grants Hub sometimes end up in there.

First things first

To avoid last minute rushes, there are a few things that you should get started on straight away to avoid submitting a late and/or non-compliant application. For example:

- gathering Letters of Support from your local First Nations community and / or organisations you are delivering your activity with
- getting your bank account statements
- seeking co-contributions for your activity.



Letters of Support

It is important that you approach anyone who will be supporting or contributing to your activity as a priority.

If you are a partnership or sole trader, you must provide a Letter of Support from the secondary organisation (educational institution or organisation / event organiser) with whom you will conduct your activity. If you are a non-Indigenous partnership or sole trader, this Letter of Support must come from your local First Nations community and/or stakeholder/s – see **Section 4.1** of the Guidelines.

If you are a non-Indigenous organisation, you are strongly encouraged to provide a Letter of Support from your local First Nations community.

If you are applying as part of a consortium, partnership or auspicing arrangement, you must include a letter from other members outlining their role in the activity - see **Section 7.3** of the Guidelines.

As discussed above, you can provide information in your application about financial and non-financial co-contributions in the application form, and this may strengthen your application. If you, other organisations or local business are contributing financially, or through donations or volunteer time, it is good to confirm this in advance and include details in your application. More information about how to complete the co-contributions section of the application form is below.

Applications submitted late due to missing and required input may not be accepted.

Bank account details

You will need to attach evidence of your organisation's bank account (either a copy of a bank statement dated within the last six (6) months, or a letter from your bank on official bank letterhead). This must be provided in a non-editable format (e.g. PDF).

You should not use a personal account unless you are a Sole Trader. Examples of acceptable documents can be found in the **Bank Account Verification Document** available on [GrantConnect](#).

We often receive last minute emails asking for assistance when bank account documents aren't readily available. To avoid delays, we strongly recommend requesting this evidence from your bank or finance department as soon as you start your application.

If your application is successful, we want to ensure payment reaches you quickly. The Community Grants Hub will attempt to verify your bank account details as a first check when they receive your application. If your details cannot be verified, either the Community Grants Hub or NIAA will contact you via email or by phone (as provided in your application). If you do not respond with valid details after we have contacted you two (2) times, your application will not be able to proceed and will be withdrawn from consideration.



Please **keep checking your spam or junk mail account and voicemail/message bank** as emails and phone call messages from NIAA and/or the Community Grants Hub sometimes end up in there.

Some reasons why your bank account details are unable to be verified include:

- your account has become dormant because the account hasn't been used in a while
- you have included an incorrect or outdated BSB number.

NSW and WA public schools

NSW and WA public schools will need to use the centralised bank accounts managed by NSW Department of Education and WA Department of Education, respectively. Each Department will manage individual payments to schools.

If you are unsure of these account details, you can contact your respective Department or NAIDOCgrants@niaa.gov.au.

You will need to use the ABN and bank account details for the Department. You do not need to attach a bank statement. Instead, please include a Word document stating: "NAIDOC Grants Team advised a bank statement is not required for the Department of Education".

Organisation details

Organisation title

Your organisation's name will auto-populate when you enter your Australian Business number (ABN) or your Organisation ID (if you have previously applied for a grant through the Community Grants Hub).

If you sit under a head organisation (for example, an Aboriginal Community Controlled Organisation (ACCO), an educational institution or an area health service), it will help us if you edit the 'Legal/Registered entity name' to include your registered business name, along with the legal entity name. For example:

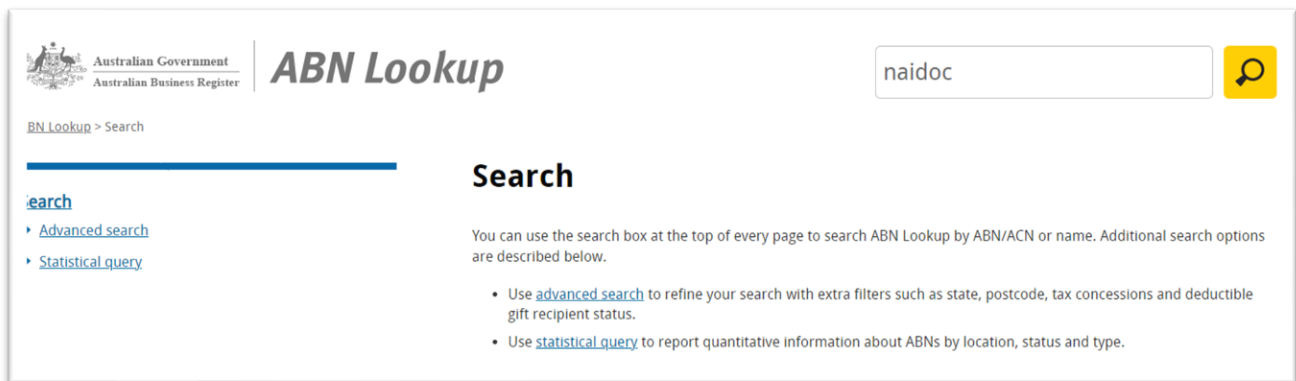
- Department of Education - Timburon College, ACT
- Childcare Australia Pty Ltd – Timburon, NSW



Your entity type

You will need to advise us in your application what your organisation's entity type is.

You can search this at [ABN Lookup](#) by entering an ABN, an Australian Company Number (ACN) or simply a name. In the example below the search was for "naidoc".



Australian Government
Australian Business Register

ABN Lookup

BN Lookup > Search

Search

You can use the search box at the top of every page to search ABN Lookup by ABN/ACN or name. Additional search options are described below.

- Use [advanced search](#) to refine your search with extra filters such as state, postcode, tax concessions and deductible gift recipient status.
- Use [statistical query](#) to report quantitative information about ABNs by location, status and type.

Search results - active ABNs and names

Active ABNs
All ABNs

Your search for **naidoc** found 24 matches. Current names with active ABNs are listed below so [search](#)

ABN	Name
70 717 007 544 ● Active	NAIDOC
30 246 271 550 ● Active	Mackay NAIDOC Incorporated
78 371 978 171 ● Active	NAIDOC Perth (Inc.)
57 990 268 152	NAIDOC SA

Click on the ABN number for the relevant organisation to find the Entity Type.



Current details	Historical details
Pdf Print Email	
ABN details help	
Entity name:	NAIDOC PERTH ABORIGINAL CORPORATION
ABN status:	Active from 29 Feb 2008
Entity type:	Other Incorporated Entity
Goods & Services Tax (GST):	Registered from 29 Feb 2008
Main business location:	WA 6005

Other Unincorporated Entity

Some organisations display on the ABN Lookup as an 'Other Unincorporated Entity' type. Many non-government educational institutions will be in this category but may also be Australian Charities and Not-for profits Commission (ACNC) registered organisations.

Current details	Historical details
ABN details	
Entity name:	HOLY FAMILY SCHOOL - BATHURST
ABN status:	Active from 01 Nov 1999
Entity type:	Other Unincorporated Entity
Goods & Services Tax (GST):	Registered from 01 Jul 2000
Main business location:	NSW 2795
Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission (ACNC)	
HOLY FAMILY SCHOOL - BATHURST is registered with the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission (ACNC). @ as follows:	
ACNC registration	
Registered as a charity view ACNC registration @	

If an organisation finds itself in this category, it will need to determine the legal entity under which contract arrangements will be made.



For example: schools registered under their relevant State or Territory's Education Standards Authority, or religious or educational institutions that pre-date the current forms of legal entities, may identify as a Statutory Entity in the NAIDOC Local Grants application form.

Most government schools will be categorised as a State/Territory Government Entity. They are not categorised as Local Government.

Identifying as an Indigenous organisation

The Application form will ask you to provide the following information:

1. Organisational Membership/Ownership
2. Organisational Board/Management Committee
3. Organisational Management
4. First Nations Employees

If you choose not to provide the NIAA with your information, we will not be able to apply our funding preference priorities to your application in deciding which organisations we will fund - see **Section 8** of the Guidelines.

You should not expect the NIAA to follow up with you if you choose not to indicate your organisation's Indigenous status.

Note: State/Territory agencies and educational institutions do not need to answer Questions 1, 2 or 3 in this section of the application form. They may however choose to answer Question 4.



Telling us about your activity

Activity title

You'll be asked to provide a title for your activity in around 38 words (maximum 250 characters).

We often receive multiple applications with exactly the same Activity Title. **Please don't use simple titles like NAIDOC Week, NAIDOC Celebration or NAIDOC School Day**, particularly if you are applying under a lead organisation (e.g. ACCO, Department of Education). This will make your application hard to find if you contact us with an inquiry.

To help us identify your application, we recommend giving your application a unique title. **Please include a location or suburb name, or your school's name, and your state, in the Activity Title** as this will make it easier for us to find your application and see how your community or region plans to celebrate NAIDOC Week.

We suggest using a title like:

- NAIDOC Family Fun Day – Survive, Revive, Come Alive, Timburon NT
- Elders Yarning Circle – Our Past, Our Present, Our Future, Timburon QLD
- Ochre Indigenous Garden Centre, South-East Land Council, Timburon SA

Make sure you check for any spelling errors in your title. If there are any spelling errors in the title or other key parts of your application, this can make it difficult for us to find your application later.

Activity description

Your Activity Description should tell us in around 300 words (maximum 2,000 characters) what you are planning to do, how the activity meets the objectives of the NAIDOC Local Grants Opportunity (see **Section 2.1** of the Guidelines), and how your local First Nations community and/or supporting organisations are involved in the activity.

Remember to tell the story of what it is you want to do so that the assessor understands what activities the grant funds will be spent on, how the activities you are proposing are culturally appropriate, or how your activity celebrates the histories, culture and/or achievements of First Nations peoples.

Your application needs to sell itself – do not assume the assessor, who may not be part of your NIAA Regional Office, knows your organisation has previously received a NAIDOC grant, or is familiar with your role in the community or your partnerships. NIAA staff are located across Australia, and those assessing your application will rely solely on the information you provide in the application form.



We've created the example below using 1,676 of the 2,000 characters available to give you an idea of the information we'd like you to tell us:

The 2026 NAIDOC Family Fun Day at Timburon Oval is planned for either 5th or 12th July 2026, depending on the weather.

The Brumby Park Aboriginal Corporation has worked with the Brumby Park Local Council and Brumby Park Regional School to bring together a range of activities that celebrate our culture.

This community was hit hard with floods in 2025 which also destroyed the school's bush tucker garden. The garden had supplied vegetables and salad greens for the canteen. We want to hold this joint activity to revive the spirits of all the community and to help the children to see the garden growing their food again.

The Council has approved the use of an all-day fire pit at Timburon Oval which will be lit following a Smoking Ceremony by local Elder Uncle Jacka. Uncle Jacka will also hold story-telling sessions with a focus on how fire helps our community through clearing the land, cooking and keeping us warm. There is a \$25 family entry fee, but this will be waived for concession card holders and pensioners.

A children's disco will be held at the Brumby Park Regional School with Uncle Jacka starting the disco with a Welcome to Country. Local band the Didgerri Do Dos will provide the music for the disco, incorporating song and dance from Indigenous artists such as Baker Boy and Mandawuy Yunupingu. The hall will be decorated with balloons and streamers in black, yellow and red. Each child will be given a *Celebrating NAIDOC Week* tote bag filled with donated goods such as a key tag, wrist band, colouring pencils and this year's NAIDOC poster.

During the school week Council staff have volunteered to work with the school to rebuild the bush tucker garden.

A note on the NAIDOC Week Theme

In previous years, applicants were required to align their activity to the annual NAIDOC Week theme. This year, **alignment is no longer required** as the theme may not be available when you start preparing your application. Once the 2026 theme is announced, it will be available on the [NAIDOC website](#).

We still encourage successful applicants to incorporate and promote the annual NAIDOC Week theme into their activity. In the lead up to NAIDOC Week, posters with the winning artwork from the [National NAIDOC Poster Competition](#) will be available and can be used as part of the promotion of your activity.



Using Artificial Intelligence (AI)

While AI can be useful in assisting, remember it only provides an interpretation of ideas. It's important to carefully check AI-generated content.

AI cannot create an accurate description of your activity or a factual response to the selection criterion. This includes demonstrating how your application represents value for money, or detailing your organisation's resources, experience and capability.



When can I hold my activity?

When we ask about the start and end dates for your activity, we want to know what day/s or period your activity/ies will take place, not when you will start your preparations.

Remember any expenses you incur before you have executed a Grant Agreement with us must be paid for by your organisation.

You should try to plan your local activity during NAIDOC Week or sometime during July. To maintain the connection between NAIDOC Week and NAIDOC local activities, **your activity must start on or after 1 July 2026.**

We know that since the late 1980s, NAIDOC Week has fallen in the school holidays which typically span a 4 - 5 week period across Australia. Ideally educational institutions should try to hold their activity during Term 3 (and as close to NAIDOC Week as possible) to help students understand the significance of the activity and its connection to NAIDOC Week.

Of course, sometimes an activity can't occur in July – for example, an entertainer might not be available or local weather patterns may get in the way. Just let us know in your application why you want to hold your activity at a later date. All activities **must be finished by 31 October 2026.**

If your application is successful, but due to unforeseen circumstances you need to change the date, you will need to let the NIAA know via the email address provided in your Letter of Offer. However, we will not give extensions for activities to occur after **31 October 2026.**

Indigenous location (ILOC) information

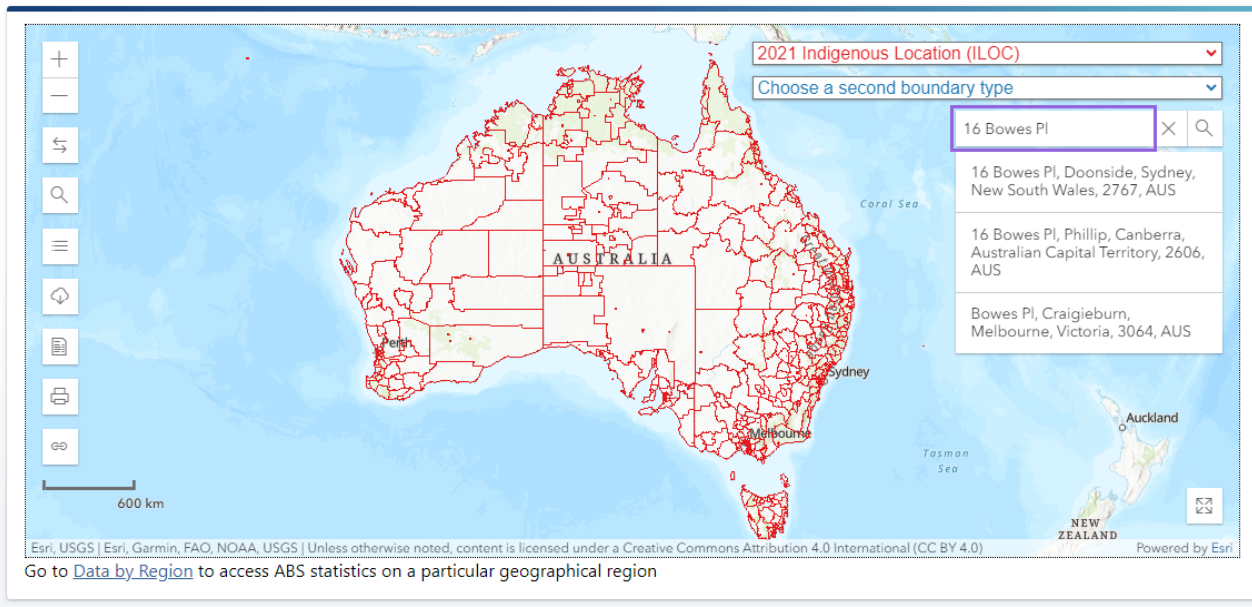
When applying, you'll be asked to enter the ILOC where the activity will be held. ILOCs are different to NIAA Regions, and we collect this information for statistical reporting purposes only.

The ILOC name may be different to your suburb or town name. The ILOC Tip Sheet on [GrantConnect](#) provides detailed instructions on how to find your correct ILOC. A summary of this information is provided below.

You can find your ILOC by going to <https://maps.abs.gov.au/>. Select **2021 Indigenous Location** from the first drop down and then enter your address. As you start typing, a drop down should appear – click your address and then the search button.

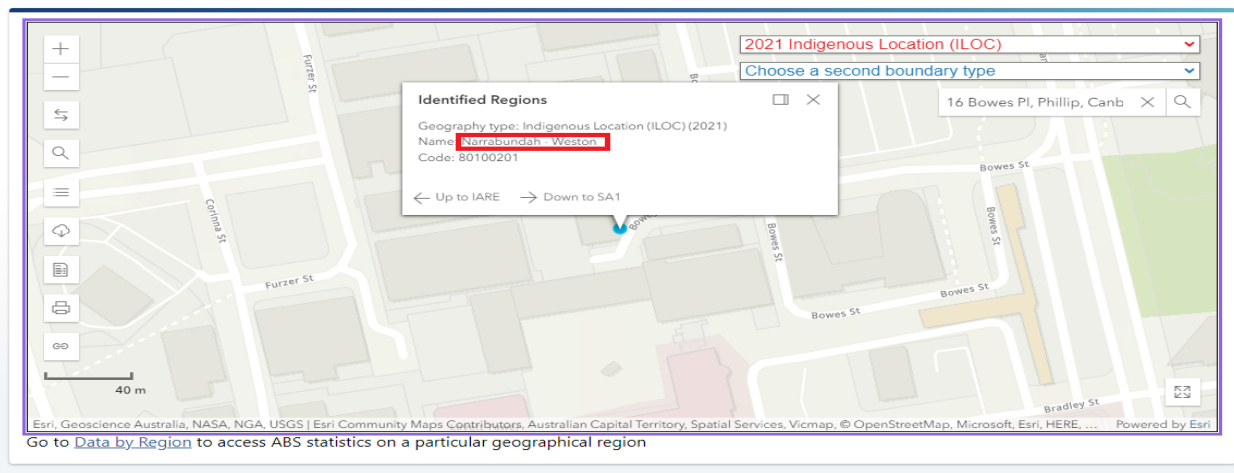


ABS Maps



Once you've hit search, click next to the dot that appears – the ILOC name will be displayed.

ABS Maps



Co-contributions

There is a section of the application form which asks you to provide information about what type of financial or non-financial co-contributions you will have as part of your activity.

Remember, NAIDOC Local Grants funding is not intended to cover the full cost of your activity and providing details of co-contributions may assist with our assessment of value for money.



The application form includes a checklist with the most common types of co-contributions that applicants usually have. You can tell us what co-contributions you are expecting by ticking the relevant boxes. If you have another type of co-contribution that you can tell us about, you can provide this by ticking 'Other' and typing a response in the free text box. This is what it looks like in the form:

Co-contributions to the activity / event will include:

- ☐ Volunteer time
- ☐ Entry fees / ticket sales
- ☐ donations (e.g. prizes, vouchers, BBQ supplies)
- ☐ Venue and equipment hire
- ☐ Sporting equipment and uniforms
- ☐ T-shirts (branded or NAIDOC-themed)
- ☐ Merchandise/advertising
- ☒ Other
- ☐ None

Details

(Limit: approx 38 words, 250 characters) 0 characters of 250 used

For applications under Stream Three - Large-Scale Grants (over \$10,000 and up to \$25,000), you can provide more detailed information in a budget style list such as who is providing the co-contribution, the value (actual or estimated) of the co-contribution and whether this co-contribution is confirmed or not.

Remember entry fees and ticket sales meet the requirements of a financial co-contribution. Volunteer time or donations of goods or services meet the requirements of a non-financial (in-kind) co-contribution.

Telling us about co-contributions you expect to receive may strengthen your application and assist with our assessment of value for money.

Selection criterion response (Large-scale grants only)

If you are applying for more than \$10,000, you will be required to respond to a single selection criterion. Your response to the criterion will be given a score from 0 to 5 and will be used to compare your application against other applications in Stream Three. If you do not score 3 or higher, your application will not be funded.



Your response should add additional information rather than include, or repeat, your Activity Description. To help our assessors decide how to score your application, please make sure your response addresses the following:

Value with relevant money

- stakeholder / local community input
- the scale and scope of the activity, and
- your resourcing and budget, including co-contributions.

Resources (this is about telling us **what you can use** to make the activity successfully happen)
For example:

- whether you will be working with the local council and/or your local Aboriginal Corporation, Aboriginal Community Controlled Organisation (ACCO) or another Indigenous organisation/s
- whether you have any sponsorships
- if there is an organisation that will provide practical and logistical support such as an organising committee with local Indigenous members or other volunteers, or who will undertake marketing and advertising of the activity
- if you have engaged other organisations such as local Indigenous businesses to provide stalls and entertainment at the activity, such as drinks, hand sanitiser, sunscreen or face painting
- if applying as a consortium, explain the role of each member – for example the Lions Club will host a community BBQ, the school P&C will organise the replanting of the bush tucker garden and the ACCO will provide a well-being activity at the Family Fun Day
- whether you have in-kind resources - for example, is your local council providing free hire of the local hall for a NAIDOC Ball, or are local ambulance, fire and/or police services attending.

Experience (this is about telling us **what you have done before** that is similar to the proposed activity). For example, you may have:

- previously managed grants for this community, either on your own or in partnership with another organisation
- previously hosted community activities and/or cultural initiatives
- an experienced event planner and/or finance manager who will work with you.

Capability (this is about **what you can do**). For example:

- are you experienced in event management or will you engage someone else to do that for you, for example, a Community Programs Facilitator
- implement a risk management plan for the activity
- how will you ensure work, health and safety guidelines and procedures are followed.



Financials

The Financials section is where you tell us about how much funding you are seeking from the NAIDOC Local Grants opportunity. If you are delivering an activity in more than one location in a *single* NIAA Region, you will need to say how much funding is requested for each location.

Remember, you must submit a separate application if your proposed activities are located in *multiple* NIAA regions. See section [Locations and Multiple Events](#) above for more information.

You can only ask for grant funds to pay for *eligible* grant activities (that is, items that are **in-cope** for NAIDOC Local Grant funding). Please see **Section 5.1** of the Guidelines for details of what funds can be used for.

If you apply for funding for *ineligible* activities (that is, items that are **out-of-scope** for NAIDOC Local Grants funding), they **will not be funded** through a NAIDOC Local Grant. Please check out **Section 5.4** of the Guidelines to see the list of what items are out-of-scope.

Budget

The budget section is where you tell us about the cost of everything you have requested funding for.

You can add up to 10 line items that outline the costs of your activity, for example, oval hire, payment for Welcome to Country and purchase of BBQ provisions. If you have more than 10 budget items, consider grouping some together so that you can fit within 10 items.

You should only include in this section the costs for **in-scope** items that the requested NAIDOC Local Grants funding will be used for – see **Section 5.1** of the Guidelines.

Other items that will be provided by other organisations or by other funding, should be included in the co-contributions section.

COVID-19

Check the latest government and health [advice](#) to ensure your activity's COVID-19 Risk Management Plan will limit the risk of transmission of COVID-19, particularly with respect to Elders and anyone with a chronic health issue.

If your proposed activity requires face-to-face delivery or is likely to result in a public gathering, you must include information (from your COVID-19 Risk Management Plan) in your application outlining how your grant activity will reduce the spread of COVID-19.

In some cases, where the Agency requires further information about how you propose to manage COVID-19 risks associated with the delivery of an activity, you may be asked to submit your COVID Risk Management Plan.



Completing the Application Form

Submitting your form

We strongly recommend you start your application as soon as possible so you can submit your application on or before the closing time. **Please note the closing time (3:00pm AEDST) will be different depending on the time zone in your location.**

Please make sure you take your location into account so that you don't miss the deadline.

- **Queensland** is one hour behind (closing time will be **2:00pm**)
- **South Australia** is half an hour behind (closing time will be **2:30pm**)
- **Northern Territory** is one and a half hours behind (closing time will be **1:30pm**)
- **Western Australia** is three hours behind (closing time will be **midday**).

When you have completed your application and submitted it, you will receive a Successful Submission Receipt email sent to the primary contact you listed in the application.

Started (but not submitted) before closing time

We understand that sometimes things happen that are out of your control, like a natural disaster or Sorry Business, which might mean you can't finish your application in time. Whatever the reason, just send an email to IASAMO@niaa.gov.au or NAIDOCgrants@niaa.gov.au so that we can see that you had started your application before the closing date and time and we can consider giving you an extension.

Please note that any assistance required with applications is provided during normal office hours (i.e. 8:30am to 5:00pm AEDST).

Late applications

We may accept a late application in exceptional circumstances (i.e. something beyond your control). You will need to contact NAIDOCgrants@niaa.gov.au and provide us with the reason you were unable to submit your application on time, for us to consider.

We can't accept late applications because:

- you forgot to apply
- we didn't tell you or your organisation about the applications being open
- the staff member who was supposed to do it has left your organisation, or
- you are new to your role and only found out about the grants after the closing date.

As outlined in the Guidelines, we reserve the right not to accept a late application.



Getting Help

If you cannot find the relevant information on [GrantConnect](#), or are having trouble with the application form, there are various sources you can use for further assistance:

- For technical assistance using [GrantConnect](#), please contact the GrantConnect Help Desk via email at GrantConnect@finance.gov.au.
- For assistance with the Application form, please contact the Community Grants Hub at [Contact us | Community Grants Hub](#);
- For inquiries about the Guidelines or your application, including funding streams, your proposal or anything else about your application details, please contact the NAIDOC Grants Team at Naidocgrants@niaa.gov.au.

It is important to note that **any discussion** you have with any of our staff about your proposed activity, or the lodgement of an application form, **does not guarantee that your activity will be funded.**



Successful Applications

We plan to let applicants know in late May / early June if they have been successful and the amount of funding they will be offered.

Applicants (including NSW and WA public schools) will be notified directly of the outcome of the application, using the [Error! Reference source not found.](#) nominated on the application form.

You will only have **5 – 10 days to review and accept the offer** as there will only be a short window to finalise Grant Agreements and to get payments out to organisations in time for NAIDOC Week. Please make sure you monitor the email address and other contact details provided in your application (see [Applicant contacts](#)) so that you do not miss this notification.

You can review the **sample Letter of Offer** available on [Grant Connect](#) ahead of time so that you are familiar with the standard terms and conditions in the Schedule of the Grant Agreement.

Funding acknowledgement

We will ask you to use the following wording to acknowledge the funding contribution from the NAIDOC Local Grants opportunity:

This NAIDOC Week Activity is delivered with funding support from the National Indigenous Australians Agency.

You should use the acknowledgement in material you print or publish in connection with your activity, including flyers, advertising materials, and social media posts (but not on merchandise, promotional gifts or giveaways).

If you go to the NAIDOC website [NAIDOC Downloads | NAIDOC](#), you can find [NAIDOC Week Brand Guidelines](#) for logos.

Changing the date of your activity

We understand that there may be unavoidable reasons why you can no longer hold your activity on the dates you originally planned.

Just send an email to the contact email address in your Letter of Offer and tell us why you want to change the date and what date you want to hold the activity.

We try to be flexible but need to know for record keeping purposes. We will not provide extensions for your activity to be held beyond **31 October 2026**.



Changes to your activity

We understand that plans can change for lots of reasons.

If you can no longer do all or part of the activity as planned, and would like to undertake a reduced or alternative activity, you will need to let us know.

You will need to send an email to the contact email address in your Letter of Offer telling us why you want to change your activity and what you propose to do instead.

The NIAA reserves the right to terminate the Grant Agreement and to request the funding be returned if the reduced or alternative proposal is not agreed to by us.

Withdrawing if you can't hold the activity

While it would be disappointing for everyone, we know that sometimes the best of plans don't always work out.

If you tell us as soon as you get the Letter of Offer, or as soon as you know after finalising the Grant Agreement, we might have time to be able to offer the grant to someone else.

Send an email to the contact email address in your Letter of Offer or Grant Agreement as soon as you can.

Unspent grant funds

We know sometimes things don't cost as much as you thought they would or you can't hold part of your planned activity because someone had to cancel.

Send an email to either NAIDOCgrants@niaa.gov.au or the contact email address in your Letter of Offer or Grant Agreement.

We can talk to you about what you need to do. You will need to tell us how much funding is left and, if necessary, we can then let you know how to return the funds back to us.

Acquitting the grant

We require a sample of grantees to acquit their grant via a Financial Declaration. We will let you know if you are in the chosen sample group at the same time as you receive your Letter of Offer. We usually sample more of the larger grants or those with a higher risk rating.

You don't need to do anything unless we ask you for a Financial Declaration.

Just remember that you need to keep your accounts handy, as we may request receipts for expenditure at any time up to five years after the Agreement Completion Date (that's usually at the end of November each year).

